

● MEDIUM

● EXPRESSION OF IDEAS

● ANSWER KEY

Rhetorical Synthesis

02

10 answers · Rationale-rich · Teach from doc

ANSWER KEY · SAT QUESTION BANK

2026-05-29

Q1**D**

- D. While there have been only about 1,200 recorded meteorite falls, there have been over 60,000 meteorite finds.

Choice D is the best answer. The sentence contrasts the number of meteorite falls with the number of meteorite finds, noting that there have been over 60,000 meteorite finds but only about 1,200 recorded meteorite falls.

Choice A is incorrect. While the sentence explains the difference between meteorite falls and meteorite finds, it doesn't contrast the number of meteorite falls and meteorite finds. Choice B is incorrect. The sentence indicates the two categories of meteorites found on Earth; it doesn't contrast the number of meteorite falls and meteorite finds. Choice C is incorrect. While the sentence notes the number of recorded meteorite falls, it doesn't contrast this with the number of meteorite finds.

Q2**D**

- D. A 2017 study concluded that ancient grass fires had caused the glass's formation, but new research suggests that the glass formed as a result of a cometary explosion close to the desert's surface.

Choice D is the best answer. The sentence describes how scientific understanding of the glass's origin has evolved, explaining that new research suggests the glass formed as a result of a cometary explosion instead of being caused by grass fires (as was previously believed).

Choice A is incorrect. The sentence explains the conclusion of the older study; it doesn't describe how scientific understanding of the glass's origin has evolved. Choice B is incorrect. While the sentence indicates that the two studies provided different explanations, it doesn't describe how scientific understanding of the glass's origin has evolved. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence references a recent finding but doesn't effectively describe how scientific understanding of the glass's origin has evolved.

Q3

A

- A. Ochoa's 1955 discovery of PNPase proved critical to deciphering the human genetic code, leading to a better understanding of how genetic variations affect human health.
-

Choice A is the best answer. The sentence emphasizes the significance of Ochoa's discovery, noting that it proved critical to deciphering the human genetic code, which resulted in a better understanding of how genetic variations affect human health.

Choice B is incorrect. While the sentence explains what Ochoa discovered, it doesn't emphasize the significance of the discovery. Choice C is incorrect. While the sentence explains what Ochoa discovered, it doesn't emphasize the significance of the discovery. Choice D is incorrect. While the sentence mentions that Ochoa's discovery was crucial, it emphasizes Ochoa's incorrect hypothesis, not the significance of the discovery.

Q4

D

- D. The SEBS rubber sample used in the 2019 study was thicker than the TPU sample.
-

Choice D is the best answer. The sentence contrasts the two samples, noting that the SEBS rubber sample, at 4 millimeters thick, was thicker than the TPU sample, which was 3 millimeters thick.

Choice A is incorrect because the sentence mentions a similarity between the TPU fiber and the SEBS rubber; it doesn't contrast the two samples. Choice B is incorrect because the sentence indicates that both the SEBS rubber and TPU samples were part of the 2019 study; it doesn't contrast the two samples. Choice C is incorrect because the sentence describes the process of torsional heating; it doesn't contrast the two samples.

Q5

A

- A. The real author of *Adam Bede* was Mary Ann Evans, who published the novel using the pseudonym George Eliot.
-

Choice A is the best answer. The sentence identifies the novel's real author, explaining that Mary Ann Evans published the novel under the pseudonym of George Eliot.

Choice B is incorrect. The sentence explains that George Eliot was assumed to be a pseudonym; it doesn't identify the novel's real author. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence specifies the pseudonym used on the novel's title page; it doesn't identify the novel's real author. Choice D is incorrect. While the sentence indicates that the novel's real author used a pseudonym, it doesn't identify that author as Mary Ann Evans.

Q6

A

- A. The international Slow Food movement, founded in 1989, promotes universal access to healthy, high-quality food that is produced sustainably by workers who are treated and compensated fairly.
-

Choice A is the best answer. The sentence effectively introduces the Slow Food movement to a new audience, explaining that the movement, which was founded in 1989, promotes universal access to high-quality and healthy food that is produced sustainably by workers who are treated fairly.

Choice B is incorrect. While the sentence indicates when the international Slow Food movement and the Slow Food USA organization were founded, it doesn't effectively introduce the movement to a new audience. Choice C is incorrect. While the sentence notes that the Slow Food movement includes advocacy for food production workers, it doesn't effectively introduce the movement to a new audience. Choice D is incorrect. While the sentence describes some of the goals of the Slow Food movement, it doesn't effectively introduce the movement to a new audience.

Q7

A

- A. At around 9,800°F, which classifies it as a G star, the Sun is hotter than most but not all of the stars within 10 parsecs of it.
-

Choice A is the best answer. Noting that the Sun (9,800°F) is hotter than most stars within 10 parsecs of it, the sentence emphasizes how hot the Sun is relative to nearby stars.

Choice B is incorrect. The sentence explains that astronomer Todd Henry determined the classifications for the Sun and several other stars nearby; it doesn't emphasize how hot the Sun is relative to nearby stars. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence explains that the majority of stars near the Sun are classified as K or M stars; it doesn't indicate the Sun's temperature or emphasize how hot it is relative to nearby stars. Choice D is incorrect. While the sentence indicates that the Sun is classified differently than most nearby stars due to its surface temperature, it doesn't emphasize how hot the Sun is relative to nearby stars.

Q8

D

- D. Taylor was the only Black woman to publish a Civil War memoir.
-

Choice D is the best answer. By indicating that Taylor's book was the only Civil War memoir published by a Black woman, this sentence emphasizes the uniqueness, or one-of-a-kind nature, of Taylor's accomplishment.

Choice A is incorrect. While the sentence describes some of Taylor's accomplishments, it doesn't emphasize the uniqueness of them. Choice B is incorrect. While the sentence describes some of Taylor's accomplishments, it doesn't emphasize that they were unique. Choice C is incorrect. While the sentence provides information about Taylor's book, it doesn't emphasize what made the book unique.

Q9

C

- C. Sister Rosetta Tharpe had such a major impact on rock 'n' roll that Celisse Henderson called her "the unquestioned founding mother" of the genre.

Choice C is the best answer. The sentence uses the quotation from Henderson to support a claim about Tharpe's contribution to rock 'n' roll, noting that the impact Tharpe had on the genre led Henderson to call her "the unquestioned founding mother of rock 'n' roll."

Choice A is incorrect. While the sentence makes the claim that Tharpe had a major impact on rock 'n' roll, it doesn't use a quotation to support this claim. Choice B is incorrect. The sentence presents Henderson's opinion that Tharpe had a major impact on rock 'n' roll, but it doesn't use a quotation to support this claim. Choice D is incorrect. While the sentence includes a quotation about audience reactions to Tharpe's music, the sentence describes Tharpe as a gospel musician; it doesn't support a claim about her contribution to rock 'n' roll.

Q10

B

- B. The cane fanner basket, which is included in the Hina Hanta online archive, is called an *ufko tapushik* in Choctaw.

Choice B is the best answer. The sentence specifies the fanner basket's name in Choctaw, noting that it's called *ufko tapushik*.

Choice A is incorrect. While the sentence mentions the fanner basket, it doesn't specify its name in Choctaw. Choice C is incorrect. While the sentence mentions the fanner basket, it doesn't specify its name in Choctaw. Choice D is incorrect. The sentence doesn't mention the fanner basket or specify its name in Choctaw.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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